Office of the Washington State Auditor

Pat McCarthy

Accountability Audit Report

Vancouver School District No. 37

For the period September 1, 2018 through August 31, 2019

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Office of the Washington State Auditor
Pat McCarthy

March 19, 2020

Board of Directors
Vancouver School District No. 37
Vancouver, Washington

Report on Accountability

Thank you for the opportunity to work with you to promote accountability, integrity and openness in government. The Office of the Washington State Auditor takes seriously our role of providing state and local governments with assurance and accountability as the independent auditor of public accounts. In this way, we strive to help government work better, cost less, deliver higher value and earn greater public trust.

Independent audits provide essential accountability and transparency for District operations. This information is valuable to management, the governing body and public stakeholders when assessing the government's stewardship of public resources.

Attached is our independent audit report on the District's compliance with applicable requirements and safeguarding of public resources for the areas we examined. We appreciate the opportunity to work with your staff and we value your cooperation during the audit.

Sincerely,

Pat McCarthy

State Auditor

Olympia, WA

Insurance Building, P.O. Box 40021 • Olympia, Washington 98504-0021 • (564) 999-0950 • Pat.McCarthy@sao.wa.gov

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AUDIT RESULTS

Results in brief

This report describes the overall results and conclusions for the areas we examined. In those selected areas, District operations complied, in all material respects, with applicable state laws, regulations, and its own policies, and provided adequate controls over the safeguarding of public resources.

In keeping with general auditing practices, we do not examine every transaction, activity, policy, internal control, or area. As a result, no information is provided on the areas that were not examined.

About the audit

This report contains the results of our independent accountability audit of Vancouver School District No. 37 from September 1, 2018 through August 31, 2019.

Management is responsible for ensuring compliance and adequate safeguarding of public resources from fraud, loss or abuse. This includes the design, implementation and maintenance of internal controls relevant to these objectives.

This audit was conducted under the authority of RCW 43.09.260, which requires the Office of the State Auditor to examine the financial affairs of all local governments. Our audit involved obtaining evidence about the District's uses of public resources, compliance with state laws and regulations and its own policies and procedures, and internal controls over such matters. The procedures performed were based on our assessment of risks in the areas we examined.

Based on our risk assessment for the year ended August 31, 2019, the areas examined were those representing the highest risk of fraud, loss, abuse, or noncompliance. We examined the following areas during this audit period:

- Associated Student Body activities at Fort Vancouver and Skyview high schools – fundraisers, gate receipts, and general cash receipting
- Cash receipting – timeliness and completeness of deposits, voids and adjustments for nutrition services, student stores, and business offices at Hudson's Bay and Columbia River high schools
- Use restricted funds – professional learning
- Establishment of local revenue and expenditure accounts
- Compliance with public work projects – prevailing wage, change orders, and retainage requirements

- Payroll – gross wages, leave balances and accruals, leave cash outs, and retroactive payments
- Accounts payable – general disbursements, electronic funds transfers, and credit cards
- Student enrollment reporting
- Open public meetings – documentation of minutes and executive sessions

RELATED REPORTS

Financial

Our opinion on the District's financial statements and compliance with federal grant program requirements is provided in a separate report, which includes the District's financial statements. That report is available on our website, http://portal.sao.wa.gov/ReportSearch.

Federal grant programs

We evaluated internal controls and tested compliance with the federal program requirements, as applicable, for the District's major federal program, which is listed in the Schedule of Findings and Questioned Costs section of the separate financial statement and single audit report. That report is available on our website, http://portal.sao.wa.gov/ReportSearch.

INFORMATION ABOUT THE DISTRICT

Vancouver School District No. 37 serves approximately 24,000 Clark County students, kindergarten through 12th grade. The District has four high schools, seven middle schools, 22 elementary schools, two buildings that serve 6th through 12th grade, and five alternative programs.

An elected, five-member Board of Directors governs the District. Board Members are elected to four-year, staggered terms. The Board appoints a Superintendent to oversee the District's daily operations as well as its approximately 3,000 employees. For the 2018-2019 fiscal year, the District had revenues of $394 million.

Contact information related to this report	
Address:	Vancouver School District No. 37 P.O. Box 8937 Vancouver, WA 98668-8937
Contact:	Amy Karcher, Budget and Grants Compliance Manager
Telephone:	(360) 313-1348
Website:	www.vansd.org

Information current as of report publish date.

Audit history

You can find current and past audit reports for Vancouver School District No. 37 at http://portal.sao.wa.gov/ReportSearch.

ABOUT THE STATE AUDITOR'S OFFICE

The State Auditor's Office is established in the state's Constitution and is part of the executive branch of state government. The State Auditor is elected by the citizens of Washington and serves four-year terms.

We work with our audit clients and citizens to achieve our vision of government that works for citizens, by helping governments work better, cost less, deliver higher value, and earn greater public trust.

In fulfilling our mission to hold state and local governments accountable for the use of public resources, we also hold ourselves accountable by continually improving our audit quality and operational efficiency and developing highly engaged and committed employees.

As an elected agency, the State Auditor's Office has the independence necessary to objectively perform audits and investigations. Our audits are designed to comply with professional standards as well as to satisfy the requirements of federal, state, and local laws.

Our audits look at financial information and compliance with state, federal and local laws on the part of all local governments, including schools, and all state agencies, including institutions of higher education. In addition, we conduct performance audits of state agencies and local governments as well as fraud, state whistleblower and citizen hotline investigations.

The results of our work are widely distributed through a variety of reports, which are available on our website and through our free, electronic subscription service.

We take our role as partners in accountability seriously, and provide training and technical assistance to governments, and have an extensive quality assurance program.

Contact information for the State Auditor's Office	
Public Records requests	PublicRecords@sao.wa.gov
Main telephone	(564) 999-0950
Toll-free Citizen Hotline	(866) 902-3900
Website	www.sao.wa.gov